

Left (top to bottom) An alfresco lunch at Zum Wenigemarkt in Erfurt; a Thuringian sausage hot from a charcoal grill; traditional Berlin currywurst from the famous Konnopke's kiosk

Below (top to bottom) *Boerewors* cooking on the barbecue at Lyhala Game Reserve, South Africa; coiled English Cumberland sausage, one of the Lake District's meaty treats



Fleischerei moderate

Torstrasse 116–118; www.fleischerei-berlin.com

A place to actually sit and eat currywurst is a rarity in Berlin, which would give this central restaurant with its simple and functional decor an edge even if its wurst weren't so good.

THE LAKE DISTRICT, UK

Cumbria's contribution to sausage culture is peppery and made of chopped meat, rather than minced, giving it a real chunkiness. Its notable characteristic is its huge length, forming a great wheel on the plate.

Mason's Arms moderate

Cartmel Fell, Grange-over-Sands, Cumbria; www.masonsarmsstrawberrybank.co.uk

High-quality local food and a great selection of local ales make this fellside inn stand out. Its Cumberland sausage embarks on a successful European adventure on a toasted ciabatta, with caramelized onions, damson chutney, and thin fries.

The Yanwath Gate Inn moderate

Yanwath, Cumbria; www.yanwathgate.com

A quintessential northern English country pub, this old inn dates back to 1683. Its chunky and peppery Cumberland sausage comes with black pudding, mashed potatoes, broccoli, carrots, and gravy.

SOUTH AFRICA

The South African *boerewors*, or "farmer's sausage," is a spicy national signature dish. It's made largely from beef seasoned with coriander and is always barbecued on a braai.

Wandie's Place inexpensive

618 Makhalemele St., Dube, Soweto, Johannesburg; www.wandies.co.za

An unpretentious eatery with long tables, colorful tablecloths, bustle, and sociable chatter that started life as a *shebeen*, or illicit bar. It now specializes in a Soweto-style festive buffet including dishes such as mutton curry, beef *potjie* (a stew), *pap* (a porridge), *umqushu* (corn and bean stew), *ting* (soft porridge), and of course *boerewors*, served both fresh from the barbecue and dried as *wors*.

Karoo Cattle and Land moderate

Irene Village Mall, Irene, Pretoria; www.karoorcattleandland.com

A great South African steakhouse that claims its *boerewors* would be the pride of any *karoo tannie* (local elderly aunt), which seems at odds with the

cosmopolitan black leather, chrome, and glass decor. But the mix is so successful that the restaurant has opened half a dozen branches.

Karibu expensive

Shop 156, The Wharf Centre, V&A Waterfront, Cape Town; www.kariburestaurant.co.za

Views of Table Mountain and the tranquil blue Atlantic prepare the palate perfectly for the restaurant's vibrant South African flavors. The chefs here are experts in barbecuing *boerewors* over open coals, then serving them with local breads such as *Kaapse broodjie*, or with *putu* and *chakalaka* (porridge and relish).

WISCONSIN, USA

Wisconsin's many German immigrants have developed old recipes to create their own signature "brats," by parboiling them in beer before grilling, part-filling them with cheddar, or lacing them with chili pepper, Cajun style.

Charcoal Inn South inexpensive

1313 South 8th Street, Sheboygan; (920) 458-6988

South Sheboygan's annual bratwurst festival is the big Wisconsin draw for sausage lovers, but when it's not on, the Charcoal Inn is the place to head to. The must-order meal here is a double brat with the works: two sausages in a bun with pickles, mustard, and raw onions, with butter oozing out on every side. As in Germany, the key to its great taste is the flavor of heavy spices unlocked by a smoky charcoal fire and superb traditional bread rolls with thin, crispy crusts and soft centers.

Milwaukee Brat House moderate

1013 3rd St., Milwaukee; www.milwaukeebrathouse.com

Though it only opened in 2008, this sausage specialist already has a cult following. Its late-19th-century brick town-house home, with stained glass, long dark-wood bar, and historic photos of Milwaukee, is the perfect backdrop for great brats from Fred Usinger's excellent butcher shop opposite the bar.

Water Street Brewery moderate

1101 N Water St., Milwaukee; www.waterstreetbrewery.com

Milwaukee has the only baseball stadium in the US where bratwurst outsell hot dogs; many of its pubs and bars feature it too. This microbrewery, with its brick warehouse interiors, adds its own signature by simmering its bratwurst in beer and mixed spices prior to grilling.